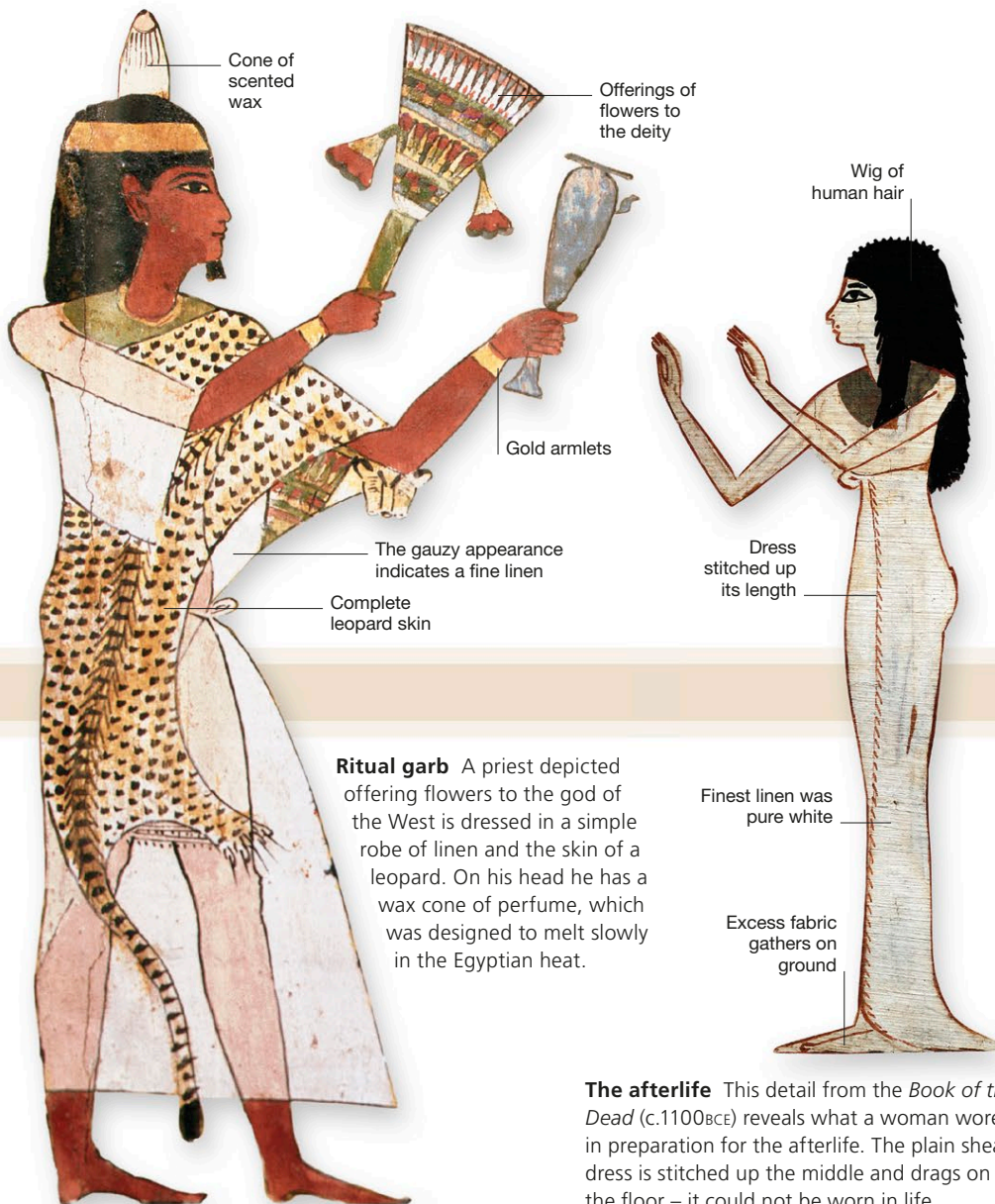




Royal robes Tutankhamun and his wife, Ankhesenamun, are wearing elaborate headdresses and wigs dyed with indigo in this image (c.1330 BCE). The pharaoh's robe is tied at the waist with ornate bands. Ankhesenamun's robe has pleats falling in different directions, showing how a long piece of cloth wraps around the body.



Princely robes A mural of a prince and his wife from the Tomb of Senneferi, Thebes, shows the couple wearing wigs. Elaborate wigs were made of human hair fixed on to a net. Their straight, plain linen robes contrast with the decorative collars, armlets, and earrings they are wearing.



Ritual garb A priest depicted offering flowers to the god of the West is dressed in a simple robe of linen and the skin of a leopard. On his head he has a wax cone of perfume, which was designed to melt slowly in the Egyptian heat.

The afterlife This detail from the *Book of the Dead* (c.1100 BCE) reveals what a woman wore in preparation for the afterlife. The plain sheath dress is stitched up the middle and drags on the floor – it could not be worn in life.

JEWELLERY



Jewellery was worn from top to toe by wealthy Egyptian men and women – and even by their sacred animals. Always colourful, the pieces featured motifs from the natural world, including green palm leaves, white lotus flowers, and yellow mandrake fruits. Gold came from Nubia (present-day Ethiopia), and silver was rarer and more expensive than gold. Semi-precious stones included lapis lazuli (imported from Afghanistan), green and red jasper, amethyst, cornelian, turquoise, and quartz. Glass and glazed composite were used to imitate precious stones. Steatite, a soft stone, was carved into small objects, including pendants and scarabs.



Gold and silver rings